

GLP-1 and Diet

Medicines like *Zepbound*, *Ozempic*, *Wegovy*, and *Saxenda* help control blood sugar, make you feel less hungry, and can help with weight loss.

Eating healthy while taking these medicines is important to help them work better and to avoid side effects like feeling sick or having an upset stomach.

Diet and lifestyle tips to support GLP-1 medication:

Timing of Meals 	• Small, frequent meals will only make you feel better. • Aim for a meal every 3-4 hours. • Will help reduce hypoglycemia if you are taking <i>other</i> diabetes medications.
Nausea 	• Small, frequent meals and adequate fluids help with nausea. • You can also try ginger or peppermint tea. • Getting enough fluids if you are throwing up is important to avoid any kidney injury. • Avoid lying down after meals for 2-3 hours. • Avoid fried foods.
Constipation and Diarrhea 	• Getting enough fiber from fruits, vegetables, and whole grains with help with diarrhea. NOTE: Be careful about potassium if you are watching that. • Be active each day. • Drink plenty of fluids, especially water. NOTE: some kidney patients have fluid limits- check with your doctor to make sure.
Protein 	• Protein goals are similar to a kidney diet. • Protein helps to grow and repair muscle that you lose while losing weight. Aim for lean meats, fish, and plant-based proteins such as beans. • Spread protein through the day. • Work with your dietitian to understand what you need.
Muscle Loss 	• Incorporate muscle exercises 2-3 times per week. This includes squats, lunges, and push-ups. • If you can lift weights, you can use a resistance band while sitting down. • Rest 48 hours between exercise to give muscles time to rebuild.
Vitamin Loss 	• Losing weight rapidly can lead to vitamin loss. • To help you get enough vitamins, it important you have a lot of variation in your diet. • Choose foods from fruits, vegetables, healthy fats, and lean proteins. • Limit empty calories such as alcohol, sugars, processed foods, and sweets.
Avoid 	• Spicy foods – Causes heartburn • High-sodium foods – increases swelling and bloating • Gas producing foods – Broccoli, cauliflower, onions, cabbage, and carbonated drinks cause discomfort • Fried and greasy foods – Causes heartburn and discomfort

GLP-1 and Weight Loss

When using GLP-1 medications to loose weight, you will want to also understand some basic food groups and why they are good for you.

Food Group	Examples	Why It's Good for You
Fruits & Vegetables	Apples, oranges, berries, spinach, kale	Give your body vitamins, minerals, and fiber to stay healthy
Whole Grains	Brown rice, oatmeal, whole-wheat bread, quinoa	Help you feel full and give you energy all day
Lean Proteins	Chicken, fish, turkey, tofu, tempeh	Help your muscles stay strong and stop you from feeling too hungry
Healthy Fats	Avocados, nuts, seeds, yogurt, olive oil, dark chocolate	Help your heart and brain and can help with weight loss

Tips for Eating Well

It is important to build good habits while you are taking GLP-1 medication. This will help you to keep healthy and achieve your weight loss goals.

Tip	What It Means	Why It Helps
Mindful Eating	Pay attention to what you're eating and why you're eating it.	Helps you make better food choices and avoid eating when not hungry.
Ask Yourself First	Before grabbing more food, ask: "Am I really hungry or just bored, sad, or stressed?"	Stops you from eating just because of feelings or habits.
Eat Slower	Take your time while eating — chew slowly and enjoy each bite.	Helps you notice when you're full and makes meals more enjoyable.

